Payments Director

Global Head of Payments; Head of Risk and Payments; Head of Fraud and Payments

JOBS TO BE DONE

PROFESSIONAL

- **Increase Authorization Rates:** I am responsible for ensuring that all the legitimate customers who want to buy are able to pay seamlessly. I want to know why banks decline our customers to ensure as many legitimate sales go through as possible. If I can move our bank auth rate by even 2-3%, that is pure revenue we would have otherwise left on the table.
- **Reduce Payment Costs:** I am responsible for minimizing our payment costs as much as possible without harming conversions. I need to understand the hidden costs of network fees and interchange markups. I route payments to the cheaper providers (where it doesn't hurt performance) and use tools like network tokenization to keep our margins from being eroded.
- **Ensure Regulatory Requirements:**
  - **PSD2:** I need to make sure that I maximize our conversion under PSD2 regulation, while minimizing friction for low-risk customers. I want to understand how to avoid blanket-3DS strategies and see if I can improve on my processor's performance.
  - **Japan 3DS:** I am reacting to Japan's new security protocols and I must ensure that 3DS friction doesn't hurt our conversions.
- **Manage Payment Infrastructure:** I maintain the technical integrations and relationship with different payment vendors. My job is to improve resiliency and prevent a single point of failure (like the Adyen outage).

PERSONAL

- **Invisible Burden:** I know that if I'm doing my job perfectly, no one in the C-suite mentions my name. I only become visible when payments fail, which means I operate under constant pressure.
- **Strategic Partner to Grow:** I'm tired of being viewed as a back-office cost center. I want to be seen as a growth driver who uses payments to increase revenue, support new markets and deliver better customer experiences.
- **Data Frustration:** I often lack the issuer data and specialized resources to truly optimize every transaction, and that gap is where we lose money.

VALUE

One Sentence Pitch

Forter works with companies like Priceline, ASOS, and Kiwi to improve their payment flow to increase resiliency and capture more sales across both digital and agentic commerce.

HIGH PRESSURE INDICATORS

What to look for in an opportunity that may indicate an urgency to change?

FINANCIALS

- Authorization rates below (**note**, use these as a guide, not as a resource for customers) source
  - Apparel, Accessories, and Beauty + Retail (US): 80-87%
  - Apparel, Accessories, and Beauty + Retail (International): 80-90%
  - Travel: 83%-90%
  - Food & Beverage: 85-95%
- 3DS % higher than 10% in non-regulated markets; higher than 15% in regulated markets

TECH / TIMING

- Adding another processor or starting to consider moving to a multiprocessor approach
- Evaluating a payment orchestration layer or tokenization vendor
- Expanding to a new region or vertical
- Looking to support agentic commerce flows
- Adding another 3rd party vendor that is required to work alongside their current stack such as subscription management, Salesforce Commerce Cloud, etc.

OPERATIONS

- Managing rulesets to determine payment routing
- Examples:
- 3DS on all orders over $100
- Route all specific BIN transactions to Adyen
- High complexity of payment tools (for example, using debit routing, network tokens, and a multiprocessor strategy)

IMPACT: WHY ACT NOW?

The Case for Immediate Action

AGENTIC COMMERCE	Payment teams are already looking toward the future of agentic channels by preparing infrastructure to process payments where the customer is an AI agent or a bot from an ecosystem like ChatGPT.
MORE TOOLS AND POSSIBILITIES	There are so many solutions in the payment toolbox (from tokenization to routing to debit rails to 3DS) it is overwhelming to manage, understand performance implications, and have them work together efficiently.
OPERATIONAL STABILITY	There is a growing fear of single-processor risk. High-profile industry outages have convinced them that using multiple processors is necessary to mitigate redundancy.
RISING FIRST-PARTY FRAUD	Using people to manually check every order is too slow and expensive as the business grows. Adding automation to the process lets the team handle more volume and stop complex fraud without hiring more staff.
PROFITABILITY-FIRST MANDATE	Moving into new markets or adding payment options attracts new types of fraud. If fraud isn't taken into account before the launch, the business will be unprotected against attacks it hasn't seen before.